SUMMARY

- A whole new life begins at conception. Organ system develop rapidly, and nutrition plays many supportive roles. Maternal nutrition before and during pregnancy affects both the mother's health and the infant's growth.
- All pregnant women must gain weight. Maternal weight gain during pregnancy correlates closely with infant birth weight, which is a strong predictor of the health and subsequent development of the infant.
- Nausea, constipation, heartburn, and food sensitivities are common nutrition related concerns during pregnancy. A few simple strategies can help alleviate the discomforts.
- Lactation is an automatic physiological process that virtually all mothers are capable of doing. Most lactating women can obtain all the nutrients they need from a well-balanced diet.
- Breast milk excels as a source of nutrients for the young infants. Its unique nutrient composition and protective factors promote optimal health development throughout the first year of life.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Amenorrhea	It is the temporary or permanent absence of menstrual periods.
Anencephaly	It is the absence of a major portion of the brain, skull, and scalp that occurs during embryonic development.
Cerebrovascular stroke	A stroke occurs when the blood supply to part of your brain is interrupted or reduced depriving brain tissue of oxygen and nutrients. Within minutes, brain cells begin to die.
Caesarean delivery	A surgically assisted birth involving removal of the foetus by an incision into the uterus, usually by way of the abdominal wall.
Down syndrome	A genetic abnormality that causes mental retardation, short stature, and flattened facial features.
Foetal alcohol syndrome (FAS)	The cluster of symptoms seen in an infant or child whose mother consumed excess alcohol during pregnancy, including retarded growth, impaired development of the central nervous system and facial malformations.
Hypocalcaemia	A condition in which the blood has too little calcium.
Hypoplasia	Underdevelopment or incomplete development of a tissue or an organ.
Low birth weight (LBW)	A birth weight of 2500gms or less, indicates probable poor health in the new-born and mother during pregnancy.

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